

XQD camera cards

Compact Flash association has announced XQD card which falls between CF and SD cards and will provide transfer speeds of 125 MB/s

How Shutter Sync works

This video gives a detailed animated explanation of how the camera's shutter sync works: <http://bit.ly/vPLDBo>

Point-and-shoot cameras test

of features and scene modes on offer. The Samsung MV-800 even has a setting where you can see a thumbnail of a pose so you can pose, or get your subject to pose, using the image as a reference! All the cameras feature what the manufacturers call an sAuto or iAuto mode, which allows you to take shots without messing about with any of the settings. The camera will automatically decide on what scene mode to use and, in our experience, the camera was spot on in most cases. The Sony DSC-TX55 also features an iAuto+ mode, which is meant to reduce noise and jitter.

All the cameras feature some sort of panorama mode. The DSC-TX55, W570 and MV800 require you to take the shot as a steady sweep from left to right, which is quite difficult in practice. The Canon uses stitch assist mode which is even more of a pain to use because it isn't very accurate. Among these cameras, the MV800 managed the best panoramas.

Ergonomically speaking, the Canon IXUS230HS was possibly the most comfortable. The body was comparatively larger and even though the menu and mode buttons were unusually placed, along the right side of the camera, they were readily accessible. The Sony DSC-TX55 and Samsung MV800 both had touch-screens so all the controls were on the screen. Compared to the Sony, the MV800's UI was sluggish, but not enough to be unusable. One irritant was the zoom lever on the Sony DSC-

TX55, the lever is tiny and a bit of a pain to use.

Performance

The IXUS 230HS performed very well in the ISO tests, producing usable images even up to ISO1600. The image quality cannot be compared with the other higher-end cameras like the SX40 HS, but it is quite good in this category. By far the worst performer was the Samsung MV800. Images at ISO200 were noisy and even at ISO400, the noise was too much for the image to be of much use. The IXUS 230HS again performed commendably in the detail and sharpness tests, beating all the other cameras in this category by a significant margin. The test images were extremely sharp and detailed, only showing a lack of texture on the darker threads of the thread box.

In the macro tests, the Samsung MV800 suffered from the worst barrel distortion, but it is only comparative as all the cameras suffered from a degree of distortion. The W570 showed a significant lack of separation between the pixels in this test, the rest of the cameras performed about the same.

The fill-flash tests saw all the cameras perform identically, with only slight variations in intensity of flash. The worst was the W570 though, with blown out images and illegible text on the laptop screen. The grey card test was, once again, a place where the IXUS 230HS took the lead, correctly exposing the grey card to reproduce the

correct intensity. The rest of the cameras underexposed the shot and will require correction. Red eye tests saw all the cameras perform at par with no red eye phenomenon visible in our test subject's eyes.

For the telephoto tests, the cameras did not really have enough zoom for purple fringing to actually manifest itself, but the IXUS 230HS managed it all the same. Considering that it has at least 3x zoom over the other cameras, this is acceptable. The image from the MV800 was awful, very blotchy with no details vis-

Videos shot on the Samsung MV800 were the worst we've seen in the tests so far, with even light reflections getting curved. Barrel distortion was very prominent and there were no details evident in even the outdoor shots. The same can be said of the W570 as well. The Canon IXUS 230HS performed extremely well in this test and, just like its bigger brother the SX40, recorded the sound of the motor while zooming in and out. The Sony TX55 presented a very noisy video indoors, but nothing as bad as the Samsung and in fact, was second only to



Canon IXUS 230HS

ible, though the colours were intact. Both the Sony cameras produced images that looked alright when zoomed out, but at a 100% crop, there were barely any details present. The IXUS 230HS produced comparatively better images with only mild blotchiness.

The DSC-TX55 and W570 performed reasonably well in the low-light test. This was expected of the DSC-TX55's EXMOR R sensor, but the W570 performed at par, if not better than, its counterpart. The Samsung MV800 managed a good showing in this test, showing good sharpness in its low-light mode. The ISO400 P-mode however, saw the DSC-TX55 taking a significant lead with much improved image quality.

the IXUS230 HS in terms of performance. One thing to note is that the DSC-TX55 showed a significant drop in quality from 1080p to 720p.

Verdict

The "Best Buy" winner in this category has to be the IXUS230HS. Good build quality, ergonomics and, most importantly, excellent image and video quality are what sets this camera apart. The Sony TX55 is also worth mentioning here. A good camera in its own right, the slim form factor and high resolution OLED display will appeal to many. The only let-down is the price, at almost ₹20,000, considering the image quality, you are mainly paying for the design. **d**

Contact sheet

Brand	Phone No	Email	Website
Canon	0124 4160000	info@canon.co.in	www.canon.co.in
FujiFilm	124-4325500	contact@fujifilmindia.com	www.fujifilm.in
Nikon	1800 102 7346	nindssupport@nikonoa.net	www.nikon.co.in
Panasonic	1800 103 1333	helpline@in.panasonic.com	www.panasonic.co.in
Samsung	1800 3008282	NA	www.samsung.com
Sony	1800-103-7799	sonyindia.care@ap.sony.com	www.sony.co.in